MIL-W-38283A(USAF)
9 May 1973

SUPERSEDING
MIL-W-38283(USAF)
17 November 1965

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

WEBBING, TEXTILE, AROMATIC POLYAMIDE, NONMELTING

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers 14 types of aromatic polyamide webbing as specified in table I.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-W-43334	Webbing and Tape, Textile, Packaging and Packing Of

STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-191	Textile Test Methods

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 8305

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2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

FEDERAL TRADE COMMISSION

Textile Fiber Products Identification Act, effective March 3, 1960.

(Copies may be obtained without charge from the Federal Trade Commission, Washington D.C. 20580.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction. This specification makes provisions for preproduction inspection.

3.2 Materials

3.2.1 Yarn. The yarn shall be a nonmelting, aromatic polyamide. The yarn shall not char at a temperature less than 675°F, when tested as specified in 4.5.

3.2.2 Twist. The final ply of the warp and filling yarns shall have a minimum of 2-1/2 turns per inch. The denier and number of single yarns specified in table I shall be twisted together (plied) in one operation.

3.3 Construction and physical properties. The finished webbing shall conform to table I and 3.3.1 through 3.6.

3.3.1 Weave

3.3.1.1 Types I, II, IV, VII, XIII and XIV. The weave for types I, II, IV, VII, XIII and XIV shall be a 2-up 2-down herringbone twill with one reversal at the center of the webbing.

3.3.1.2 Types III, V and VI. The weave for types III, V and VI shall be a double plain weave with a single filling. Separate binder warp ends shall weave 2-up and 2-down, 1 end as 1. All other warp yarns shall weave 2 ends as 1 except that the edge warp yarns shall weave 1 end as 1 not exceeding 8 ends on one selvage and 9 on the other selvage.

3.3.1.3 Types VIII, IX and X. The weave for types VIII, IX, and X shall be a 5-up, 1-down, 1-up, 5-down herringbone twill with 1 reversal at the center of the webbing. The weave is shown in figure 1.

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Table I. Construction and physical properties

Type	Width (inches)	Thickness (inches)	Weight (max) (oz/linear yard)	Breaking strength (lb)(min)	Ends in warp (min) Face and Back	Binder	Total
I	9/16±1/32	.025-.040	0.28	500	70	-	70
II	1±1/32	.015-.030	0.40	600	80	-	80
III	1-23/32±1/16	.080-.11	2.75	5,500	223	27	250
IV	1-23/32±1/16	.055-.075	1.75	3,600	154	-	154
V	3-1/32±1/8	.070-.110	4.50	9,000	359	44	403
VI	1-23/32±1/16	.145-.175	4.35	8,700	241	29	259
VII	1-23/32±1/16	.015-.030	0.70	1,200	146	-	146
VIII	1-23/32±1/16	.090-.120	3.0	6,500	272	-	272
IX	1±1/16	.140-.175	2.70	6,000	252	-	252
X	1-3/4±1/16	.140-.175	4.30	10,000	282	-	282
XI	1±1/16	.220-.260	4.10	9,000	184	15	199
XII	1-23/32±1/16	.09-.12	3.4	7,300	305	-	305
XIII	1-1/4±1/32	.015-.030	0.50	800	106	-	106
XIV	1±1/32	.060-.080	1.20	2,500	104	-	192
XV	1-1/2±1/16	.045-.065	1.35	1,700	143	34	177

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Table I. Construction and physical properties (Continued)

Type	Picks per inch (min)	No. of Yarns for final plied yarns (min)			Yarn denier		
		Warp	Binder	Filling	Warp	Binder	Filling
I	34	4	-	2	200	-	200
II	34	4	-	2	200	-	200
III	20	2	1	2	1,200	1,200	1,200
IV	16	2	-	1	1,200	-	1,200
V	22	2	1	2	1,200	1,200	1,200
VI	18	3	1	2	1,200	1,200	1,200
VII	34	4	-	2	200	-	200
VIII	17	2	-	2	1,200	-	1,200
IX	17	2	-	2	1,200	-	1,200
X	17	3	-	2	1,200	-	1,200
XI	18	4	1	2	1,200	1,200	1,200
XII	17	2	-	2	1,200	-	1,200
XIII	34	4	-	2	200	-	200
XIV	14	2	-	1	1,200	-	1,200
XV	47	1	1	1	1,200	1,200	1,200

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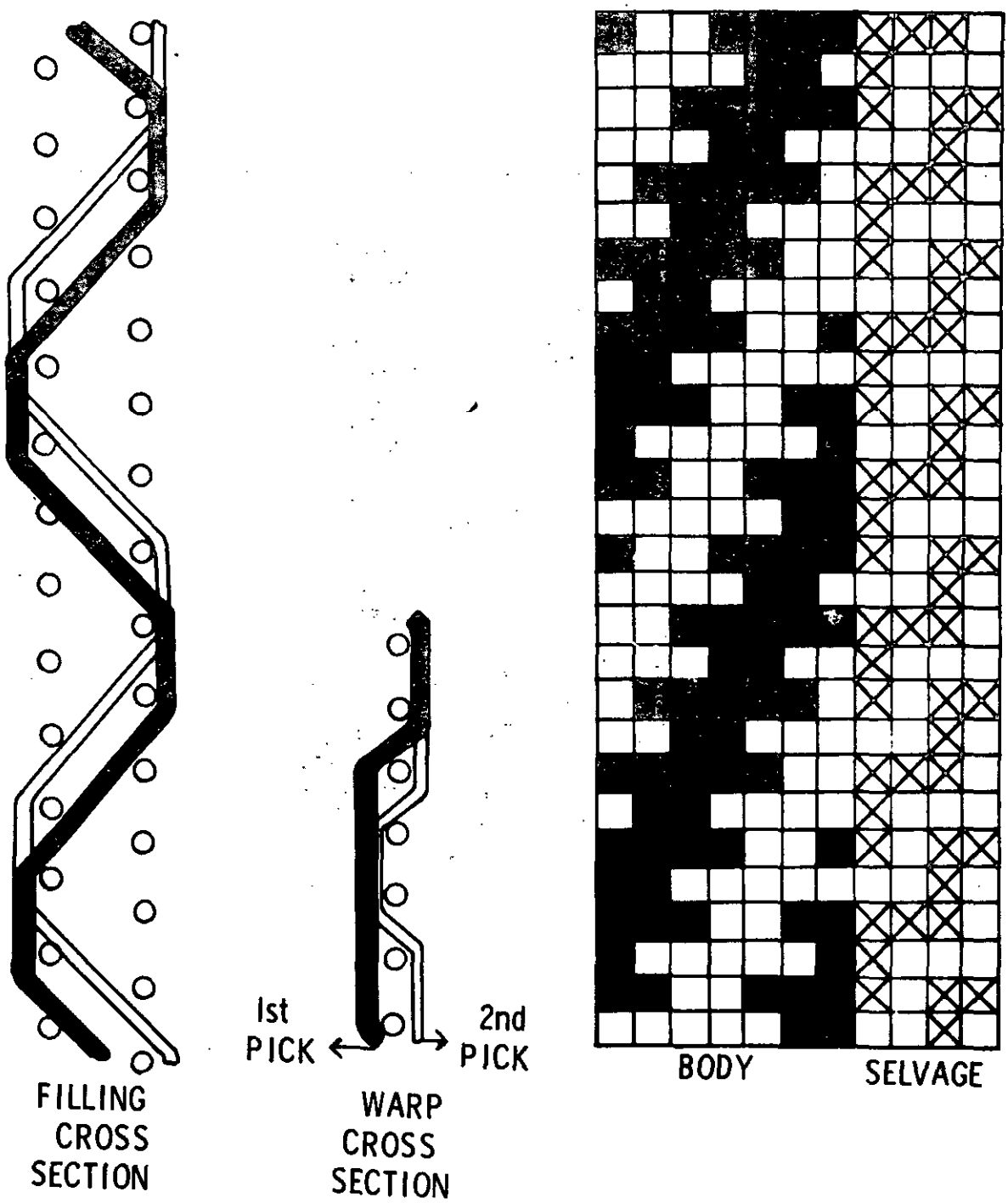


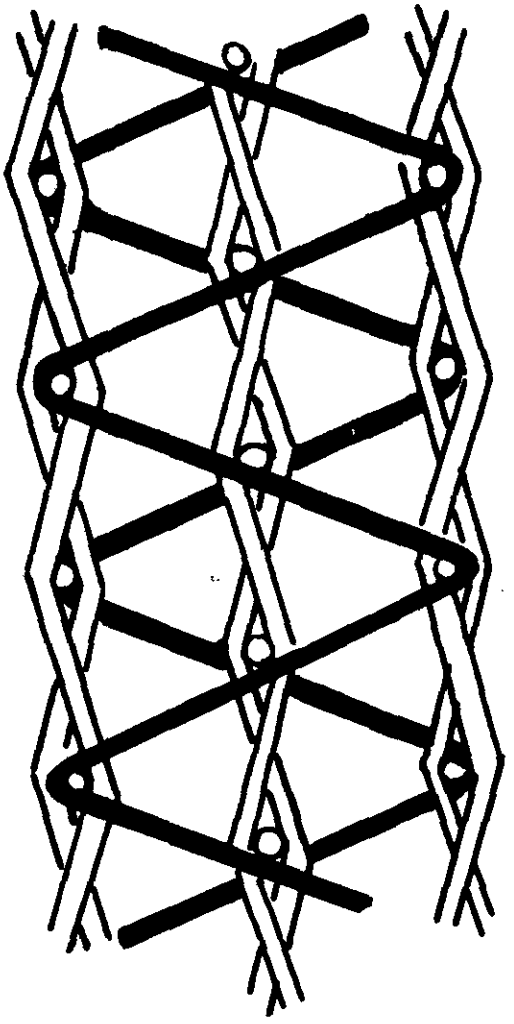
FIGURE I. WEAVE DIAGRAM - TYPES VIII, IX AND X

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3.3.1.4 Type XI. The weave for type XI shall be as shown in figure 2.

3.3.1.5 Type XII. The weave for type XII shall be as shown in figure 3.

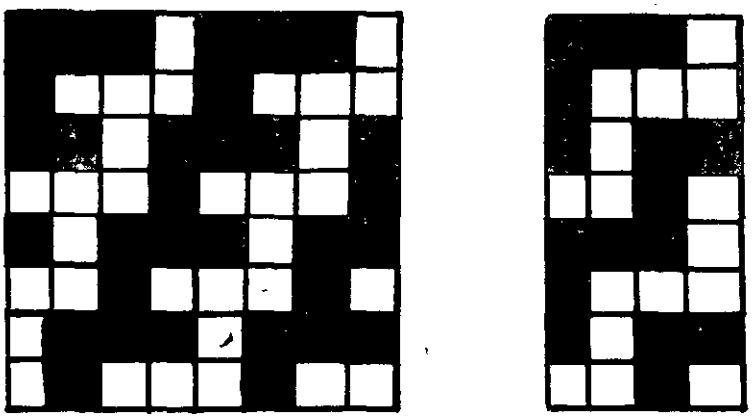
3.3.1.6 Type XV. The weave for type XV shall be as shown in figure 4.



WARP YARNS--WEAVING ONE END AS ONE
BINDER YARNS--WEAVE ONE END AS ONE

FIGURE 2. CROSS SECTION FILLING - TYPE XI

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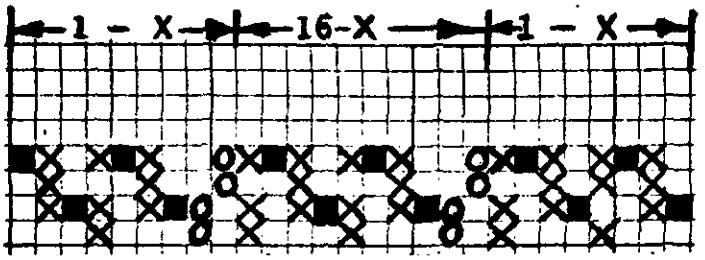
BODY SELVAGE

BODY WEAVE - 1/3 TWILL WITH THE BACK FILLING TWO ENDS WEAVING AS ONE.

SELVAGE WEAVE - DOUBLE PLAIN WEAVE, FIVE ENDS ON ONE EDGE; SIX ENDS ON OTHER EDGE; ONE END WEAVING AS ONE.

FIGURE 3. WEAVE DIAGRAM - TYPE XII

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= Face warp yarn
= Back warp yarn
= Binder warp yarn

Figure 4. Weave diagram - Type XV

3.3.2 Aging. All types of webbing shall be oven aged and shall not lose more than 15 percent of the original breaking strength, when tested in accordance with table IV.

3.3.3 Resin treatment. Types I, IV, VIII, and XII webbings shall be polyvinyl butyral plasticized with butyl ricinoleate suitably applied by water dispersion, dried and cured to form a firmly adherent and evenly distributed deposit or coating on the yarns of the webbing. The curing of the resin shall be conducted within the temperature range of 240° to 360°F as specified in table IV.

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3.3.3.1 Extractable matter. All types of resin treated webbing shall contain a maximum of 8.5 percent by weight of matter extractable in methyl-ethyl-ketone, when tested as specified in 4.7.2.1.

3.3.4 Resistance to abrasion (types I, IV, VIII and XII). After resin treated and when abraded, types I and IV webbing shall retain not less than 75 percent of the original breaking strength and types VIII and XII shall retain not less than 85 percent of the original breaking strength, when tested in accordance with 4.7.3.

3.4 Color. Unless otherwise specified, the color of the webbing shall be Olive Green 106 solution dyed.

3.5 Length. Unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity, each roll of webbing shall contain 90 to 110 yards. No roll shall contain more than 3 pieces, and no piece shall be less than 10 yards in length.

3.6 Identification of product. Each roll shall have an identification ticket attached with not finer than 5-ply cotton string doubled to not less than 6 inches long. The tickets shall be made of paperboard not less than 0.020 inch in thickness and the color shall be manila or light in intensity to permit easy reading of printed, stamped or typed markings. Handwritten entries shall be prohibited. The ticket shall have clipped corners at the end where a reinforcing patch (with or without a metal eyelet) is firmly affixed for attaching the tying string. The ticket shall be legibly printed with water insoluble ink with the following information:

Stock Number
Type (and Width)
Nomenclature
Specification Number
Yardage
Contract Number and date of manufacture
(month and year)
Contractor's name

3.7 Fiber identification. Each roll of webbing shall be labeled, ticketed, or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act, effective 3 March 1960.

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3.8 Workmanship. The finished webbing shall be clean, evenly woven and shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the levels set by the applicable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection of the webbing shall be classified as follows:

a. Preproduction inspection.

b. Quality conformance inspection.

4.3 Preproduction inspection. Preproduction inspection shall consist of all the inspections and tests as specified in 4.5 and 4.7.

4.3.1 Samples. The preproduction samples shall consist of 20 yards of all types of webbing. An additional 10 yards of webbing, prior to resin treatment, shall be furnished on types I, IV, VIII and XII. Samples shall be tested in a laboratory designated by the procuring activity, or, when so stated in the contract or order, at the contractor's plant under the inspection of the procuring activity (see 6.2).

4.3.2 Report. The contractor shall furnish a certified test report on all preproduction samples when tested in accordance with 4.5 and 4.7.

4.3.3 Previous approval. At the discretion of the procuring activity preproduction inspection may be waived for webbing which has been accepted under a previous contract.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall consist of the inspections, examinations and tests specified in 4.5, 4.6 and 4.7.

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4.4.1 Sampling and inspection. Except when otherwise specified, sampling and inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5 Inspection of components. The yarns shall conform to the physical characteristics of table II.

Table II. Testing of components

Characteristics	Requirement reference	Test method
Yarn:		
Aromatic polyamide	3.2.1	1/
Denier	Table I	4021 1/
Carbonization	3.2.1	1534
Ply	Table I	Visual
Twist 2/	3.2.2	4054

1/ Requirement accepted on basis of contractor's certification of compliance.
2/ One test on each of 5-yarn supply packages.

4.5.1 Carbonization

4.5.1.1 Apparatus. A suitable melting point apparatus meeting test method requirements, shall be used to determine the carbonization point of the yarns.

4.5.1.2 Procedure. A sufficient number of fibers shall be removed from the yarn sample for observation of carbonization. The temperature at which the yarn begins to stiffen or char shall be considered the end point of the test.

4.6 Examination of the end item

4.6.1 Yarn-by-yard examination. The required yardage of each piece shall be inspected on both sides and visual defects classified as listed in table III. All defects found shall be counted regardless of their proximity one to another, except where two or more defects represent a single local condition of the webbing, in which case only the more serious defect shall be counted. A continuous defect shall be counted as one defect for each warpwise yard or fraction thereof in which it occurs. The sample unit for this examination shall be 1 linear yard. The sample size shall be in

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accordance with inspection level III of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 0.4 major defects and 2.5 total defects per 100 units (yards). The lot size shall be expressed in units of 1 linear yard each. An approximate equal number of yards shall be examined for each roll selected. The number of rolls from which the sample is to be selected shall be as specified herein.

Lot size (yards)	Sample size (rolls)	Number of defects acceptable in sample (maximum)
Up to 1300 1/	3	0
1301 to 3200	5	0
3201 to 8000	7	0
8001 to 22,000	10	0
22,001 to 110,000	15	0
110,001 and over	25	1

1/ If a lot contains fewer than 3 rolls, each roll in the lot shall be examined.

4.6.2 Overall examination. Each defect listed below shall be counted no more than once in each roll examined. The sample unit for this examination shall be one roll. The sample size and acceptance number shall be as shown in 4.6.1. The lot size shall be expressed in units of 1 linear yard each.

Defects

Objectionable odor
Unclean throughout
Off shade, i.e., not within established tolerance
Uneven shading, spottiness, poor penetration
Uneven weaving throughout

4.6.3 Examination for length

4.6.3.1 Individual roll. Each roll in the sample shall be examined for the defects listed below. The sample unit for this examination shall be one roll. The sample size and acceptance number shall be as shown in 4.6.1. The lot size shall be expressed in units of 1 linear yard each.

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Defects

Gross length less than specified minimum length or more than specified maximum length.
Gross length more than 2 yards less than gross length marked on piece ticket.
Any piece less than 10 yards in length.
Any roll containing more than 3 pieces.

4.6.3.2 Total yardage in sample. The lot shall be unacceptable if the total of the actual gross lengths of rolls in the sample is less than the total of the gross lengths marked on roll tickets.

4.6.4 Examination for compliance with Textile Fiber Products Identification Act. During the examination of individual roll for length, each roll in the sample shall be examined for conformance to the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act. Each roll not labeled in accordance with this act shall be a defect. The lot shall be unacceptable if two or more of these defects occur.

4.6.5 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements comply with Section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed herein shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per 100 units.

Examination	Defect
Marking (interior and exterior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling.
	Bulging or distortion of containers.
Weight	Weight of contents exceeds requirements.

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Table III. Classification of defects

Defect	Description 1/	Major	Minor
Abrasion marks	Resulting in rupture of yarns, or in nap sufficient to obscure the identity of any yarn exceeding 10 percent of width or 1 inch in length.	X	
Broken or missing end	Two or more regardless of length or a single end exceeding 6 inches in length.	X	
	Single end under 6 inches but exceeding 1/4 inch.		X
Broken or missing pick	Two or more regardless of extent. Note: The filling tie-in or joining shall not be construed as a defect of any nature.	X	
Coarse or light filling bar	Resulting in visible difference in stiffness or thickness of webbing and extending for more than 1/4 inch in the length direction.	X	
	Resulting in visible difference in stiffness or thickness of webbing and extending for 1/4 inch or less in the length direction.		X
Twist or distortion	Webbing will not lay flat upon application of manual pressure due to twist or distortion.		X
Cut, hole, or tear	Any cut, hole, or tear.	X	
Drop-ply	Clearly visible, on more than 2 ends within same length and extending over 9 linear inches or more.	X	
	Clearly visible, on 1 or 2 ends within same length and extending over 9 linear inches or more.		X
Edge beaded or corded	Visible increase in edge thickness or misformed edge.		X

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Table III. Classification of defects (Continued)

Defect	Description 1/	Major	Minor
Edge loopy	Forming clearly visible filling loops, or edges tied loosely to body of webbing for 2 linear inches or more.	X	
Edge loose (slack)	Waviness, distortion in orientation of filling, or looseness along edge.	X	
Edge cut, torn, or frayed	Clearly visible along edge.	X	
Edge tight	Visible tension along edge, or waviness, that cannot be flattened by manual pressure.	X	
Edge scalloped	Any indentation of edges above allowable tolerances.	X	
Floats or skips	Multiple, 1/2 inch or more in combined warp and filling directions or single float or skip over more than 1 inch.	X	
	Multiple, less than 1/2 inch in combined warp or filling directions or single float or skip over more than 1/2 inch but not exceeding 1 inch, if in warp, or more than 1/4 inch of the width but not exceeding 1 inch, if in filling.		X
Hitchback crack	Clearly visible opening between adjoining picks, or warpwise tension area over part of the width resulting in visible light and heavy places.		X

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Table III. Classification of defects (Continued)

Defect	Description 1/	Major	Minor
Jerked-in filling, slough-off, slug	A clearly visible loop of filling pulled in at edges.		X
Kinks	More than 3 in any 9 linear inches.	X	
Knots	More than 1 knot in any 9 linear inches.	X	
	One knot every 2 yards with untrimmed ends extending from surface of webbing.		X
Mispick, double pick	Two or more across the full width.	X	
	Single across the full width.		X
Slack end	Two or more in the same length, jerked in between picks, or forming clearly visible loops on the surface.	X	
	Single jerked in between picks, or forming clearly visible loops on the surface.		X
Slub or slug, gout	More than twice the thickness of the yarn (or ply, if plied).		X
Smash	Any smash.	X	
Spot, stain, or streak 2/	Any clearly visible dirt, rust, grease, oil spot, stain, or streak.	X	
Tight end	Clearly visible up to 12 inches in length.	X	

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Table III. Classification of defects

Defect	Description 1/	Major	Minor
Wrong draw	Extending for more than 9 inches.	X	
Identification	Misplaced.	X	
	Missing.	X	

1/ The normal visual inspection distance shall be approximately 3 feet.

2/ For use in special purpose items, any spot, stain or streak up to 12 inches in length that can be covered with an approved white spotter shall be minor. Any spot, stain or streak that can not be covered or is longer than 12 inches shall be a major defect.

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Table IV. Test Methods

Characteristics	Requirement reference	FED-STD-191 test and reference	No. of determinations per individual sample unit	Results reported as
Width	Table I	5020	3	Nearest 1/16 inch
Thickness	Table I	5030 1/	3	Nearest 0.001 inch
Weight	Table I	5040	3	Nearest 0.01 ounce
Yarns per inch				
Face and back	Table I	5050 2/	3	Nearest whole no.
Binder	Table I	5050 2/	3	Nearest whole no.
Picks per inch	Table I	5050	3	Nearest whole no.
Weave	3.3.1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Breaking strength				
Original	Table I	4108	5	Nearest 1.0 pound
After aging	3.3.2	4108	5	Nearest 1.0 percent
After abrasion Type I, IV, VIII, and XII	3.3.4	4108	5	Nearest 0.1 percent
Resin treatment	3.3.3	3/	5	Nearest 0.1 percent
Extractable matter	3.3.1	4.7.2.1	5	Nearest 0.1 percent

1/ Except that a 6-ounce total load shall be applied and the presser foot shall be a 3/8 inch.
2/ Determination shall be made on full width of webbing.
3/ A certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirements.

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4.7 Testing of the end item. The methods of testing specified in FED-STD-191, wherever applicable and as listed in table IV shall be followed. Except for breaking strength, the physical and chemical values specified in Section 3 apply to the average of the determinations made on a sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test methods. For breaking strength, any individual determination less than the minimum requirement shall constitute failure. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more samples fail to meet any requirement specified. The lot size shall be expressed in units of 1 linear yard. The sample unit for testing shall be 8 linear yards of types I, II, and XIII webbing; 20 linear yards of all other types and, in addition, 10 linear yards of types I, IV, VIII and XII webbing prior to resin treatment. The sample size shall be as follows:

Lot size (yards)	Number of samples
800 or less	2
801 to 1,000	3
10,000 and over	5

4.7.1 Breaking strength - after aging. Five specimens, 40 inches in length and full width, shall be used in the aging tests. The specimens shall be placed in an oven at 500° ± 10°F for 4 hours. Upon removal, the specimens shall be conditioned at standard conditions for 4 hours and then tested for breaking strength. The breaking strength shall be the average of results obtained from the specimens tested. The loss in breaking strength (B.S.) shall be calculated as follows:

$$\frac{\text{Original B.S.} - \text{B.S. after aging}}{\text{Original B.S.}} \times 100 = \text{Loss in B.S.} \qquad (1)$$

4.7.2 Resin treatment

4.7.2.1 Extractable matter. The extractable matter, inclusive of the resin deposit, shall be determined on a specimen of approximately 5 grams of the webbing. The sample, after separation of the warp and filling yarns, shall be dried to constant weight in a weighing bottle at a temperature of 220° ± 8°F (104° ± 4.5°C). After a 6-hour extraction with methyl-ethyl-ketone in a Soxhlet apparatus, the final weight of the extracted sample shall be obtained after constant weight has been obtained under the previous drying conditions.

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$$\text{Percent extractable matter} = \frac{\text{Loss in weight on extraction}}{\text{Original dry weight of sample}} \times 100 \qquad (2)$$

4.7.3 Resistance to abrasion (types I, IV, VIII and XII). Five specimens, 40 inches in length and full width, shall be tested for abrasion resistance on a device conforming to figure 5. New abrading edges of hexagonal rod (C) shall be used for each specimen tested. The webbing (A) shall have one end attached to weight (B). The webbing shall pass over the hexagonal rod (C) and shall be attached to the oscillating drum (D). The drum shall oscillate so that the webbing is given a 12 ± 1 inch traverse over the rod at the rate of 60 ± 2 strokes per minute. After 5000 strokes the webbing shall be removed and the breaking strength shall be determined. The breaking strength shall be the average of results obtained from the specimens tested and the loss in breaking strength (B. S.) shall be calculated as follows:

$$\frac{\text{Original B. S. - B. S. after abrasion}}{\text{Original B. S.}} \times 100 = \text{Loss in B. S.} \qquad (3)$$

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, packing and marking. The webbing shall be packaged, packed and marked in accordance with MIL-W-43334.

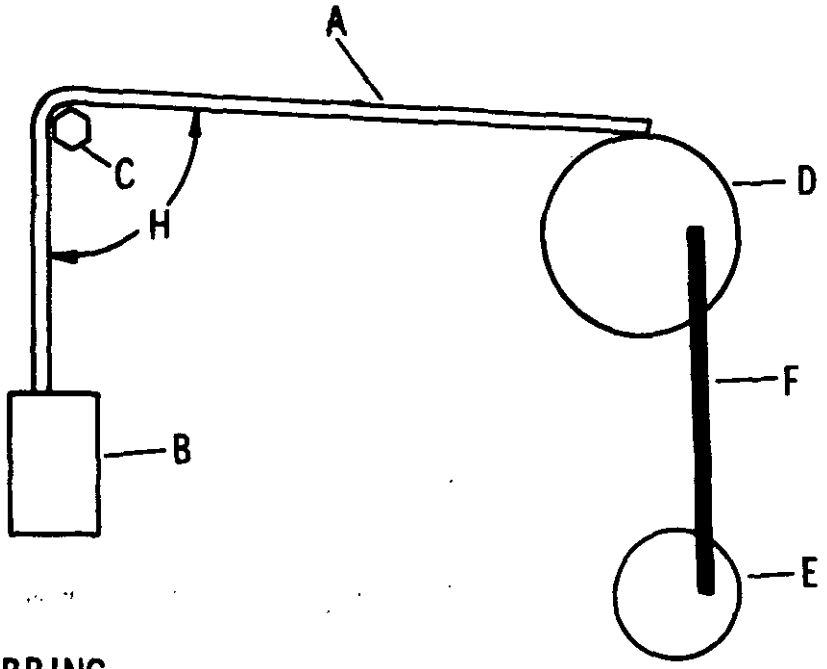
6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The webbing covered by this specification is intended for use in parachutes and their accessories, tow target reinforcement, safety belts, bomb hoists and slings, tie-down equipment, and overrun barriers.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Point of preproduction inspection (see 4.3.1).
c. When preproduction sample approval is required (see 4.3.3).
d. Type (see table I).
e. Quantity.
f. Length of roll.
g. Applicable levels of packaging and packing.

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A--WEBBING
B--WEIGHT SHALL BE 5.2 POUNDS ±2 OUNCES
C--1/4-INCH HEXAGON ROD, PHYSICAL CONDITION--AS ROLLED;
SURFACE CONDITION--COLD FINISH;
ROCKWELL HARDNESS--MINIMUM B-97, MAXIMUM B-101
D--DRUM, 16-INCH DIAMETER
E--CRANK
F--CRANK ARM
H--ANGLE FORMED BY WEBBING 85 ±2 DEGREES

FIGURE 5. DEVICE FOR TESTING ABRASION RESISTANCE

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6.3 NOMEX (formerly called HT-1), manufactured by the E. I. duPont deNemours and Company, Inc., is an acceptable yarn.

Custodian:
Air Force - 11

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 11

PROJECT NUMBER: 8305-F291

Review activities:
Air Force - 11, 67

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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